The Bloom in the Battle

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Manuscript excerpt

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“The wilderness and the solitary place shall be glad for them; and the desert shall rejoice, and blossom as the rose.”

The Ransomed Shall Return

Isa 35:1 The wilderness and the solitary place shall be glad for them; and the desert shall rejoice, and blossom as the rose.

Isa 35:2 It shall blossom abundantly, and rejoice even with joy and singing: the glory of Lebanon shall be given unto it, the excellency of Carmel and Sharon, they shall see the glory of the LORD, and the excellency of our God.

Isa 35:3 Strengthen ye the weak hands, and confirm the feeble knees.

Isa 35:4 Say to them that are of a fearful heart, Be strong, fear not: behold, your God will come with vengeance, even God with a recompence; he will come and save you.

Isa 35:5 Then the eyes of the blind shall be opened, and the ears of the deaf shall be unstopped.

Isa 35:6 Then shall the lame man leap as an hart, and the tongue of the dumb sing: for in the wilderness shall waters break out, and streams in the desert.

Isa 35:7 And the parched ground shall become a pool, and the thirsty land springs of water: in the habitation of dragons, where each lay, shall be grass with reeds and rushes.

Isa 35:8 And an highway shall be there, and a way, and it shall be called The way of holiness; the unclean shall not pass over it; but it shall be for those: the wayfaring men, though fools, shall not err therein.

Isa 35:9 No lion shall be there, nor any ravenous beast shall go up thereon, it shall not be found there; but the redeemed shall walk there:

Isa 35:10 And the ransomed of the LORD shall return, and come to Zion with songs and everlasting joy upon their heads: they shall obtain joy and gladness, and sorrow and sighing shall flee away.

Opening Illustration: Beauty in Hostile Soil

Some of the world’s most extraordinary flowers don’t bloom in soft soil or controlled greenhouses. They rise in adversity and shout life where death tried to settle.

The Desert Rose –

Native Regions: East Africa & the Arabian Peninsula

Spiritual Parallel: Thrives with little—proves that what’s in you is stronger than what’s around you.

Facts:

Known as the “impala lily” or “mock azalea.”

Stores water in its thick, swollen trunk (caudex), allowing it to survive months without rain.

Produces bright pink, red, or white blooms—even when the surrounding land is barren.

Its sap is toxic—used in traditional African hunting as poison. (Beauty that’s not to be played with!)

The Fire Lily –

Native Regions: South Africa (especially after wildfires)

Spiritual Parallel: Doesn’t bloom until everything around it has burned down—it’s a resurrection plant.

Facts:

A true “pyrophile”—it needs fire to bloom!

The heat and chemicals from wildfires trigger its growth and flowering cycle.

Blooms within 9–12 days after a burn, bringing color back to charred landscapes.

Its bulbs lay dormant underground, waiting for the fire to clear the way.

The Himalayan Blue Poppy –

Native Regions: The high altitudes of the Himalayas, especially Tibet

Spiritual Parallel: Blooms where others can’t breathe—some anointings are born in high places of isolation.

Facts:

One of the most elusive and rare blooms in the world.

Needs cold temperatures, rocky soil, and high altitude (10,000+ ft) to survive.

Its blue petals seem to glow—called “sky-flower” by Tibetan locals.

Takes years to bloom after planting, but the flower lasts only a few days—beauty born from patience.

Edelweiss –

Native Regions: The Alps (Austria, Switzerland, Italy)

Spiritual Parallel: Symbol of courage and loyalty—blooms in the cold, high places where fear would freeze most out.

Facts:

Nicknamed “The Noble White” or "Flower of the Brave."